



1-12-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=er4T-h3yp68
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Muncie Community Schools Board of Education Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 12, 2021

Body: Board of Education & Board of Finance

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer President Williams called the regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education to order.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal (President), Mr. Heater, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Love, Mrs. Spales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin. (Note: Presiding officer role is noted as President Williams in staff introductions, and Dr. O'Neal during roll call/proceedings).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:13 The Pledge of Allegiance was led virtually by student pledge leaders: Kyra Oliver, Vincent Snyder, Angelina Rivera Wilson, Anaya Jackson, Elijah

Higgins, Zadia Sawyer, and Verity Flanders.

- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Prior meeting minutes disposition not explicitly detailed in transcript).*
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **01:23:53 Extension of Sick Leave / EFMLA**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal / Central Office Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** With the federal Families First Coronavirus Response Act (FFCRA) expiring on December 31, 2020, the board discussed voluntarily continuing to offer paid sick leave and expanded family medical leave for COVID-19-related reasons under the same terms and conditions until vaccines become widely available to school employees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:27:59 Permission to Advertise: Network Technology via E-Rate Funds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome / Central Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for legal advertisement to purchase network technology utilizing federal e-rate funds exceeding \$50,000. Bids are expected by March 1st and will return to the board on March 9th.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:29:45 Cyber Insurance, Workers' Comp, and Property & Casualty Insurance Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the 2021 insurance renewals. By reducing the property and casualty premium by over \$94,000 and combining it with cyber insurance and workers' comp renewals, the district achieved a total net premium reduction of over \$8,000 compared to the previous year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:32:11 Depreciation Policy Update: Useful Life for Roof Projects**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Update to the district's depreciation policy following a state board audit, correcting the useful life of roof projects from 50 years to 25 years to match the actual 25-year roof guarantees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:33:18 Resolution to Transfer Amounts from Education Fund to Operations Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual resolution allowing the district to transfer funds from the Education Fund to the Operations Fund, capped at a safe threshold of 15% (targeting 14.99%) to avoid state excessive transfer lists and maximize funding for teacher compensation.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:51:54** The presiding officer called for public comments; no members of the public stepped forward to speak.
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5. Administrative Updates & Reports

- **00:02:34 Westview Elementary School Presentation:** Principal Mr. Ambler, Master Teacher Tammy Bell, and Mentor Teachers Aisha Allen and Kelsey Pavelka presented updates on Westview Elementary. Highlights included stable staffing, community partnerships (Ball State, Second Harvest, Westview Community Association, Westminster Presbyterian), neighborhood garden grants, Professional Learning Communities (PLCs), and a video-sharing initiative capturing exemplar teaching practices.
- **00:44:18 Superintendent's Update (Dr. Wyakowski):**
 - High school students received 650 new Chromebooks, with full rollout concluding by the end of the week.
 - A new round of Pandemic EBT (P-EBT) cards will be uploaded for virtual learners and quarantined students.
 - Process checks are ongoing across district schools.
 - The High Ability (Extended Learning Program - ELP) committee is working on marketing the program to surrounding districts.
 - Grissom Elementary experienced a temporary heating issue; students were safely fed lunch and sent home early with minimal disruption.
 - MLK Youth Citizenship Awards will be distributed via a virtual video production this Friday.
- **00:53:29 Formative Assessments Update (Ms. Smithson):** Presentation on transitioning district formative assessments to **i-Ready** for grades K-8. The program strongly correlates with state ILearn assessments, provides instantaneous personalized learning paths, pinpoints sub-skills, and includes robust professional development support for teachers.
- **01:34:18 Financial Report (Brad Jerome):**
 - Total cash balance across all funds ended 2020 at **\$27.9 million**.
 - Education fund cash surplus reached \$2.7 million; rainy-day fund stands at over \$9.4 million.
 - The \$12 million state loan is being actively amortized at \$50,000/month, leaving an outstanding balance of \$11.7 million.
 - Property tax collections are impacted by circuit breaker tax caps, collecting roughly \$10.8 million of the levy.

6. Board of Finance Meeting & Adjournment

- **01:42:33 Board of Finance Session:** The regular board meeting was temporarily adjourned to convene the statutory Board of Finance. Mr. Heater was appointed President of the Board of Finance, and Mrs. Barnes Griffin was appointed Secretary. Brad Jerome presented the annual financial health indicators, noting \$79,000 in earned interest, stable cash reserves, and positive multi-year fiscal trends. The Board of Finance meeting was subsequently adjourned.
 - **Adjournment:** The regular meeting concluded following the Board of Finance business.
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